



I always thought: 'I'm gonna make it, but not for now'. I also got a mental coach whom I talked to from that moment. I think it helped me a lot. I still do it in both my bad and good times to keep up my stability," she said.

When Paris came knocking, Yibbi was prepared. Not only did the Dutch team end up winning the gold medal, but individually also, Yibbi bagged the golden stick for having sounded the boards nine times.

"You would always want to perform better than you did before. Last year, I really enjoyed playing in

the Olympics because that was always my dream. And winning the gold medal has been the highlight of my career. As an athlete, I was so happy, and I enjoyed that, but now it's a new year and I have new goals. I want to perform well, and

« I like to watch other athletes as well, not just hockey players »

Making merry: Yibbi Jansen was the joint top-scorer of the Women's HIL, alongside JSW Soorma Hockey Club's Charlotte Englebert, with five goals.

SHASHI SHEKAR KASHYAP

hopefully, it will be as good a year as the last one, or maybe better," the FIH 2024 Player of the Year said.

She has, undoubtedly, started the season with a bang. **The Warriors, led by Neha Goyal, won a historic title in the first edition of the only commercial women's hockey league in the world.** Yibbi added to her honour roll by becoming the joint top-scorer of the tournament, alongside JSW Soorma Hockey Club's Charlotte Englebert, with five goals.

Sharing her thoughts on the tournament, Yibbi said it had been a learning curve for her. "I have enjoyed the experience of playing with girls from across the globe. The games were intense and close. The HIL is a good platform to ensure the future of Indian hockey is bright, allowing its girls to play matches at the highest level. The style of Indian players is very different from the ones I play with in the Netherlands. They are very skilled. They want to eliminate a player, while we are used to easy passing. I've learned to be open to different styles now," she said.

She was, by a fair distance, the best drag-flicking exponent, having registered five of the 11 short corners that were converted in the entire tournament. At present, she is arguably also the best penalty corner specialist in the sport globally.

"I have changed a lot of things about my drag-flick since I started playing. I train the most with my drag-flick coach Toon Siepman (since her days at Oranje-Rood in 2016-17), and I practise four times a week